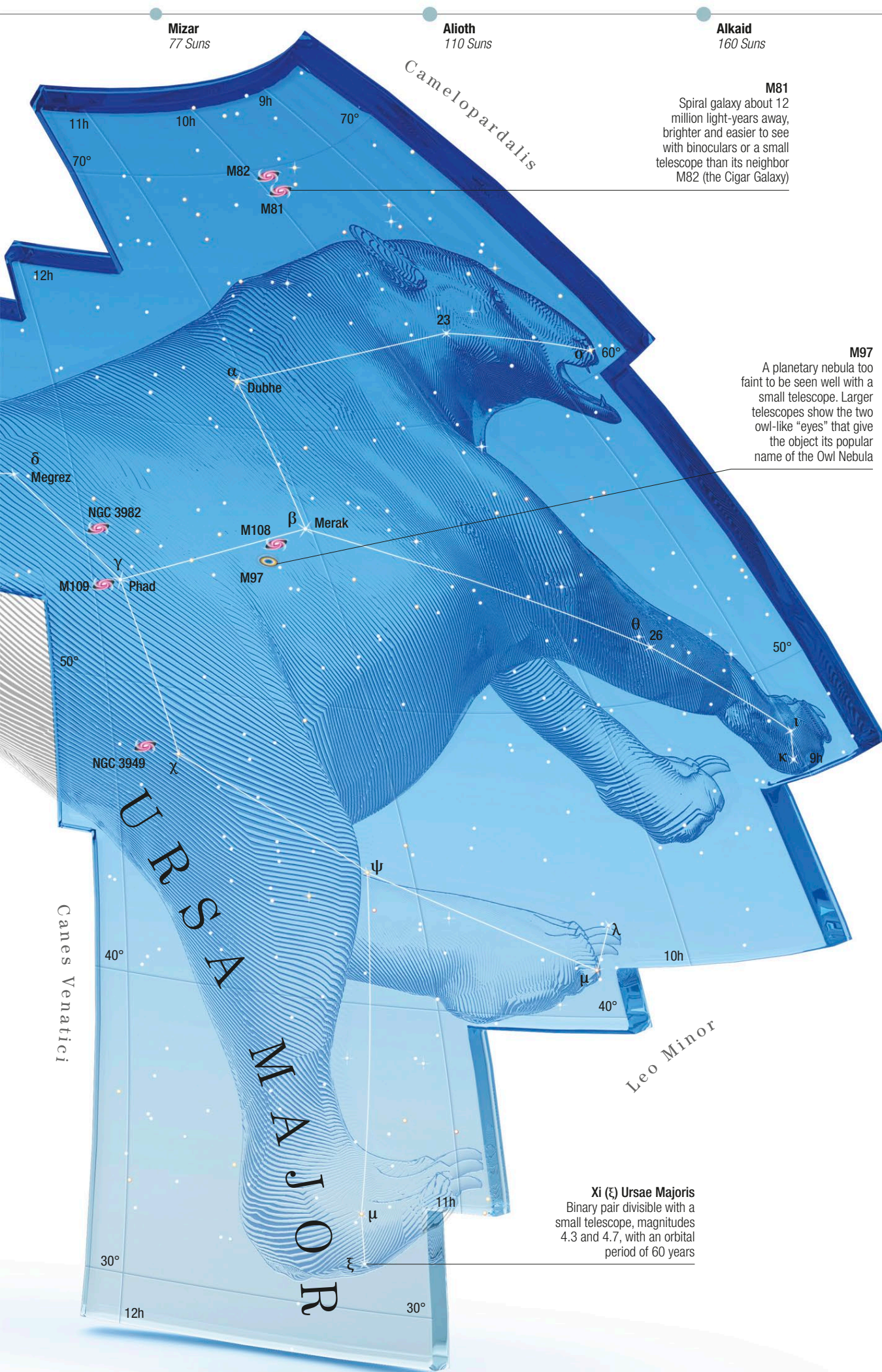




M81
Spiral galaxy about 12 million light-years away, brighter and easier to see with binoculars or a small telescope than its neighbor M82 (the Cigar Galaxy)

M97
A planetary nebula too faint to be seen well with a small telescope. Larger telescopes show the two owl-like "eyes" that give the object its popular name of the Owl Nebula

Xi (ξ) Ursae Majoris
Binary pair divisible with a small telescope, magnitudes 4.3 and 4.7, with an orbital period of 60 years

KEY DATA

Size ranking 3
Brightest stars Dubhe (α) 1.8, Alioth (ε) 1.8
Genitive Ursae Majoris
Abbreviation UMa
Highest in sky at 10pm February–May
Fully visible 90°N–16°S



CHART 5

MAIN STARS

Dubhe Alpha (α) Ursae Majoris
Yellow giant

☼ 1.8 ↔ 123 light-years

Merak Beta (β) Ursae Majoris
Blue-white subgiant

☼ 2.4 ↔ 80 light-years

Phad Gamma (γ) Ursae Majoris
Blue-white main-sequence star, also known as Phecda
☼ 2.4 ↔ 83 light-years

Megrez Delta (δ) Ursae Majoris
Blue-white main-sequence star
☼ 3.3 ↔ 81 light-years

Alioth Epsilon (ε) Ursae Majoris
Blue-white giant or subgiant

☼ 1.8 ↔ 83 light-years

Mizar Zeta (ζ) Ursae Majoris
Blue-white main-sequence star
☼ 2.3 ↔ 86 light-years

Alkaid Eta (η) Ursae Majoris
Blue-white main-sequence star
☼ 1.9 ↔ 104 light-years

Xi (ξ) Ursae Majoris
Binary of yellow-white main-sequence stars
☼ 4.3, 4.7 ↔ 29 light-years

DEEP-SKY OBJECTS

M81
Spiral galaxy

M82 (Cigar Galaxy)
Edge-on disturbed spiral galaxy

M97 (Owl Nebula)
Planetary nebula

M101 (Pinwheel Galaxy)
Spiral galaxy

NGC 3982
Spiral galaxy